

COMIC

Guardians of the Galaxy #2 and #3

★★★★★ | The art is just top notch, so we will be focusing on the story by Al Elwing. With the comics and the movies coming closer together in the Marvel refreshes, these comics give tantalising hints to the future direction of the MCU, and a glimpse of the larger universe beyond what we see on screen. The civil war between the Utopians and the Imperialists, two factions of the Kree continues to rage. The Skrulls continue to dispatch their war fleets. Gamora just wants to chill with her family, the GoTG and retire from the messy business of saving the galaxy. But Rocket and Star Lord cannot help themselves, and escape on another adventure, only to meet with the Olympus Gods who are far more powerful than them. The ship they are using is no longer the Milano,



but the Bowie. There are some funny references, Star Lord takes an arrow to the knee, shot by Artemis. Star Lord spills the blood of a god, Hephaestus who is making some kind of space zombie army, and Zeus straight up makes him disappear in a black hole bomb. We actually get to see Rocket crying in the arms of Hercules, showing his emotional side. He vows to bring Quill back.

Back to the team, we see something really strange. Drax now only says "I am Drax", and Gamora only says "I am Gamora" while Groot can talk like any other normal tree. Maybe this is what it feels like to be Groot? What follows is a whole bunch of panels where the only dialogues are the characters saying their own names, except for Groot. This is a brilliant section, and the comics are worth reading only for these pages. It is surprising how much action and emotion is conveyed in these panels, and the one line dialogues actually enhance the experience, and actually add context to the story. Something like this can only be pulled off by those who have really mastered their art. Gamora is dealing with her loss, and she snaps out of it, ready to save the galaxy again. Star Lord remains dead for now, but then the comic gets really surreal. We see a team similar to Quill and Rocket, called O'Hare and the Prince (a furball and royalty) and the two are given an assignment to kill Rocket. With the Kree, Skrulls, Olympians, Guardians and these new anthropomorphic creatures, there are a lot of pieces in this story and we cannot wait to see where it takes us next.

TV SHOW

Space Force

★★★★★ | Steve Carell and Greg Daniels' latest venture since the acclaimed US version of The Office, Space Force, came out to some incredibly harsh reviews from critics. After having watched it ourselves, we honestly have no idea what was going through their minds, we definitely very much enjoyed the show from start to finish. People going into the show expecting something similar to The Office will be disappointed, but that's the point, the show isn't trying to be anything like The Office. The problem we feel lies in people constantly drawing comparisons.

Anyway, coming back to the show itself, we had a blast. The whole thing



begins because the current president of the United States demanded that they have a 'Space Force', so General Mark Naird (Steve Carell) has been promoted and made responsible for heading the new Space Force. Naird's right hand, Dr. Adrian Mallory (played

by John Malkovich) is the brains of the whole operation. There's an interesting dynamic between the two, who have very different mindsets, with Naird being the tough-as-nails duty-bound General and Mallory being governed by reason and logic and choosing to bend the rules if need be. However, they both have a deep respect for each other, and the series does a great job of portraying it, and how they put aside their differences to work together. There's plenty more factors at work here too, like the dynamic at a military base with the scientists and soldiers not exactly getting along, Naird's home-life situation which has taken a turn for the worse, and so much more. The show's definitely deeper than it gets credit for. Overall, Space Force was a fun watch, and it ends on a serious cliffhanger, we're looking forward to the next season.